

(Albert) Bo ZHAO

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Current Position

Associate Professor, School of Finance, Nankai University	2026–present
Assistant Professor, School of Finance, Nankai University	2016–2026

Research Interests

Political Economy, Asset Pricing, Applied Econometrics and Machine Learning

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, The University of Hong Kong	2011–2016
M.Sc. in Financial Engineering, Xiamen University	2008–2011
B.Sc. in Computational Mathematics, Nanjing University	2003–2007

Publications

1. [Does Securities Regulation Matter? Mandatory Disclosure, Excess Stock Volatility, and the US Securities Exchange Act of 1934](#), 2026, *Journal of Law and Economics*, with Sheng Li, Chenggang Xu.
2. [Is Machine Learning a Necessity? A Regression-based Approach for Stock Return Prediction](#), 2025, *Journal of Empirical Finance*, with Tingting Cheng, Shan Jiang, Junyi Zhao.
3. [Complete Subset Averaging Methods in Corporate Bond Return Prediction](#), 2023, *Finance Research Letters*, with Tingting Cheng, Shan Jiang, Zhimin Jia.
4. [Stock Return Prediction: Stacking a Variety of Models](#), 2022, *Journal of Empirical Finance*, with Tingting Cheng.
5. [The Impact of COVID-19 Pandemic on the Volatility Connectedness Network of Global Stock Market](#), 2022, *Pacific-Basin Finance Journal*, with Tingting Cheng, Junli Liu, Wenying Yao.

Working Papers

1. *Predicting the Predictable: Decomposing and Forecasting Stock Returns in a Data-rich Environment*, with Tingting Cheng, Xuanbin Yang.
Reject & Resubmit at Management Science.
2. *Combination Forecast of Corporate Bond Return: An Ensemble Learning Approach*, with Tingting Cheng, Shan Jiang, Hai Lin, Chunchi Wu.
Revise & Resubmit at Journal of Banking and Finance.
3. *Direction is More Important than Speed: A Comparison of Discrete and Continuous Modeling of Stock Excess Returns*, with Tingting Cheng.
4. *Revisiting Incentive Issues in China's Central-Local Top-Down Hierarchy*, with Chenggang Xu, Ziao Zhao.

Teaching

A History of Economic Methodology (Undergraduate)	2026
Quantitative Investment (Master/undergraduate)	Spring 2019–2026
Econometrics I (Undergraduate)	Spring 2025
Intermediate Econometrics (Master)	Fall 2017–2021
Risk Management (Master)	Spring 2018, 2019
Advanced Econometrics (Ph.D.)	Spring 2017

Other Experiences

Bond Analyst, China Bond Insurance Company	2011
Financial Risk Manager (FRM)	2014